

Carlos Bethencourt

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Departamento de Economía

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EDUCATION

- Ph.D., Universidad Carlos III de Madrid (UC3M), 2003
- M.A., Universidad Carlos III de Madrid (UC3M), 1998
- B.A., Universidad de La Laguna (ULL), School of Economics, 1996

ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP

- Research Coordinator, “Development, inequality and environment (DECENT)”, ULL, 2008-present.
- Representative of the University of La Laguna in the Government of the Canary Islands (Reto Demográfico Program), ULL, 2023-present.
- Head of M.A. programs, Ph.D. school ULL (EDEP), 2023-present.
- Secretary, Department of Economics, ULL, 2020-2022.
- Subhead, Department of Economics, ULL, 2019.
- Principal Investigator and Co-Investigator in multiple national research projects, 2004–present.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics, Behavioral Economics, Macroeconomics, Political Economics, Family Economics, Public Economics, Labor Economics, Economics of Crime, Education.

WORK EXPERIENCE

- Professor, Department of Economics, ULL, 2025-present.
- Associate Professor, Department of Economics, ULL, 2008-2025.
- Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, ULL, 2000-2007.
- Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, UC3M, 1997-1999.
- Research Assistant, Department of Economics, ULL, 1995-1996.
- Visiting Scholar, Christian Michelsen Institute, January-July 2022.
- Visiting Scholar, University of Stavanger, February-March 2019.
- Visiting Scholar, Monash University, March 2018-July 2018.
- Visiting Scholar, University of Osaka, February 2015-July 2015.
- Visiting Scholar, University of Minnesota, March-May 2014.
- Visiting Scholar, University of Pennsylvania, multiple long visits (4 months or more), 2001-2005.
- Research fellow, CEDESOG, 2008-present.
- Research fellow, EQUALITAS, 2022-present.
- Research fellow, CAERP, 2004-present.
- Research fellow, Population Studies Center (UPenn), 2004-2006.
- Member of executive committee, Chair in Economics and Mobility (ULL), 2023-present.

National

- Team member in the 2024POB17. La desigualdad en Riqueza y en Renta en Canarias: colectivos vulnerables, pobreza y brecha de género. Fundación CajaCanarias y Fundación Bancaria “la Caixa”, 2025-2028.
- Co-leader in the PID2022-137352NB-C44. Desigualdades y Oportunidades: el papel de la educación, la salud y las políticas medioambientales y fiscales. Spanish Ministry of Science and Innovation (Programa I+D Excelencia), 2023-2026.
- Team member in the 2020EDU10. Desigualdad de Oportunidades en el aprendizaje y brechas educativas en Canarias (EduCanDO). Fundación CajaCanarias y Fundación Bancaria “la Caixa”, 2021-2024.
- Co-leader in the PID2019-107161GB-C33. Investigación en desarrollo y desigualdad, innovación y medioambiente (i-DEINNOVE). Spanish Ministry of Science and Technology (Programa I+D de Excelencia), 2020-2022.
- Team member in the EducaTe-LAB. Laboratorio para la Evaluación de la Calidad Educativa en Tenerife. Convocatoria “Agustín de Betancourt” 2019, Gobierno de Canarias, 2020-2023.
- Co-leader in the ECO2016-76818-C3-2-P. Inquiries in human capital and inequality, technology and the environment - 2. Spanish Ministry of Science and Technology, 2017-2019.
- Team member in the ProID2017010088. Clima, Salud y Malaria en Africa: impactos en pobreza y biodiversidad. Proyectos de I+D del Gobierno de Canarias, 2017-2019.
- Team member in the ECO2013-48884-C3-3-P. Inquiries in human capital and inequality, technology and the environment. Spanish Ministry of Science and Technology, 2014-2016.
- Team member in the ULL.PUENTE.14.04. Investigación sobre capital humano y desigualdad, y sobre tecnología y el medio ambiente. Universidad de La Laguna, 2014.
- Team member in the ECO2009-09614. Entendiendo la oferta de trabajo femenina y sus implicaciones. Spanish Ministry of Economics and Competitiveness – Secretaría de Estado de Investigación, Desarrollo e Innovación, 2010-2013.
- Project leader in the El problema de la evasión fiscal: determinantes e implicaciones. Programa de apoyo a jóvenes doctores, 2012-2013.

International

- Participant in the AEQUITAS. Assessment and engineering of equitable, unbiased, impartial and trustworthy AI systems (Proyecto Europeo Horizon H2020). European Commission, European Union, 2022-2025.
- Participant in the P30 AG12836. The Implications of Education by Education for Fertility. PARC/Boettner Center for Pensions and Retirement Security at University of Pennsylvania, NIA and NIH, 2005-2006.
- Participant in the P30 AG12826. The Living Arrangements of Elderly Widows. PARC/Boettner Center for Pensions and Retirement Security at University of Pennsylvania, NIA and NIH, 2003-2004.

RESEARCH CONTRACTS

- “Desigualdad de Oportunidades en Rendimiento Educativo en la Enseñanza Obligatoria de Canarias”. Fundación Canaria General de la Universidad de La Laguna, Gobierno de Canarias, October 2019 - December 2020. (with L. Cabrera and G. Sicilia).
- “Desigualdades Educativas en el Proceso de Enseñanza a Distancia durante el Cierre Escolar: Diagnóstico de Necesidades y Oportunidades en Santa Cruz de Tenerife”. Ayuntamiento de Santa Cruz de Tenerife, June 2020 - October 2020. (with G. Sicilia and L. Cabrera).
- “Annual Report of the Economic and Social Council of the Canary Islands 2020”. Corporación Cinco Análisis y Estrategias, February 2020 - March 2020. (with G.A. Marrero).
- “Cooperation Agreement for the Development of Research on the Implementation of the Catalogue of Services and Benefits of the Public Social Services System”. Spanish Ministry of Social Rights, Equality, Diversity and Youth, Government of the Canary Islands, 2021–2022. (with G. Marrero, M. Álvarez and L. Aguilera).
- Collaboration with the Canary Islands branch of the General Workers’ Union (UGT) in the design of the economic proposal for the “Agreement for the Protection of Employment, Social Protection, the Economy and the Strengthening of the Tourism Sector in the Canary Islands” and in the review of the “Pact for the Social and Economic Reactivation of the Canary Islands (COVID-19 crisis)”. Government of the Canary Islands.

Journals

- *The American Economic Review, American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Economic Journal, Journal of European Economic Association, Journal of Public Economics, Quantitative Economics, European Journal of Political Economy, International Economic Review, Journal of Population Economics, Economic Inquiry, Review of Development Economics, Public Choice, Journal of Public Economic Theory, Journal of Economics, CESifo Economic Studies.*

Agencies of evaluation

- Evaluator, European Research Executive Agency (REA), European Commission (2025-present).
- Evaluator, Spanish State Research Agency (AEI), Spanish Ministry of Science, Innovation and Universities, Spain (2016-present).
- Evaluator, Spanish National Agency for Evaluation and Foresight (ANEP), Ministry of Science and Innovation, Spain (2011-2015).

INVITED SEMINARS

TU Dortmund University, Osaka University, Monash University, Australian National University, University of Stavanger, Christian Michelsen Institute (CMI), University of Vigo, Universitat de las Illes Balears.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Membership of Boards, commissions

- Coordinator of Student Mobility (Economics and Business Programs), ULL, September 2014 - July 2015.
- Member of the Faculty Board, School of Economics, Business and Tourism, ULL, 2010-present.
- Member of the Academic Committee (COA), Master's Program in Applied Analysis for the Social Sciences, 2023-present.
- Member of the Academic Committee (COA) of the School of Economics, 2015-2017.
- Member of the Internship Recognition Committee of the School of Economics, 2008-2014.
- Member of the Quality Assurance Committee, School of Business Studies, 2008-2010.
- Member of the Infrastructure Committee of the School of Economics, 2010-2012.
- Member of the Technical Committee for Credit Recognition of the School of Economics, 2020-2021.
- Secretary of the PhD Committee of the Department of Economics, 2004-2019.
- Member of the Research Committee of the Department of Economics, 2005-2019.
- Member of the Graduate (Third Cycle) Committee of the Department of Economics, 2001-2019.
- Member of the Teaching Committee of the Department of Economics, 2001-2019.
- Coordinator of Macroeconomics, ULL, 2009-2010.
- Course Coordinator: Economics, Macroeconomics, Macroeconomics II, III and IV, ULL.
- Member of the Office for Guidance and Work Placement (GOICT), serving as coordinator and supervisor of student internships, 2008–2012.
- Member of the Jury for the STEAM Future 2025 Program, evaluating innovation projects presented by secondary schools, May 2025.
- Supervisor of External Internships, School of Business Studies, 2007–2012.

Academic juries

- PhD Thesis Evaluation Committee (1), 2023.
- Master's Thesis (TFM) Evaluation Committee (18), 2020–2025.
- Bachelor's Thesis (TFG) Evaluation Committee (16), 2013–2020.

BOOK CHAPTERS

- “Desigualdades educativas en el proceso de enseñanza a distancia durante el cierre escolar: diagnóstico de necesidades y oportunidades en S.C. de Tenerife”, 2020. (with Cabrera, L., Sicilia, G., Marrero, G. and C.N. Pérez).
- “Desigualdad de Oportunidades en rendimiento académico en la educación primaria y secundaria obligatoria en Canarias”, 2023. (with G.A. Marrero, G. Sicilia, L. Cabrera, C.N. Pérez and A.S. Marrero).
- “Desigualdad de Oportunidades educativas en la educación primaria y secundaria obligatoria en Canarias”, 2024. (with G.A. Marrero, G. Sicilia, L. Cabrera, C.N. Pérez, A.S. Marrero and D. Bianchi).

- Gender-Role Identity in Adolescence and Women Fertility in Adulthood (2025) *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, vol. 240. (with Daniel Santos).
- Foreign Aid and Corruption: Unveiling the Obstacles to Effective Development (2025) *Southern Economic Journal*, vol. 91. (with Fernando Perera-Tallo).
- Partially Funded Social Security and Growth (2024) *Metroeconomica*, vol. 76. (with Lars Kunze and Fernando Perera-Tallo).
- Public Sector and Human Capital: On the Mechanics of Economic Development (2024) *Journal of Economics*, vol. 143. (with Fernando Perera-Tallo).
- The Role of Institutions in Shaping the Growth-Aid Relationship (2024) *Journal of Macroeconomics*, vol. 80. (with Fernando Perera-Tallo).
- The Fight Against Malaria: A New Index for Quantifying and Assessing Policy Implementation Actions to Reduce Malaria Burden in Sub-Saharan Africa (2023) *Journal of Development Studies*, vol. 59. (with Gustavo Marrero and Charlie Ngoudji).
- The Economics of Crime and Socialization: The Role of the Family (2022) *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, vol. 197. (with Lars Kunze).
- Crime and Social Expenditure: A Political Economic Approach (2022) *European Journal of Political Economy*, vol. 75.
- On the Relationship Between Sectorial and Institutional Structural Changes (2020) *Metroeconomica*, vol. 71(3). (with Fernando Perera-Tallo).
- Social Norms and Economic Growth in a Model with Labor and Capital Income Tax Evasion (2020) *Economic Modelling*, vol. 86. (with Lars Kunze).
- The Living Arrangements of Elderly Widows, Their Children and Their Children's Spouses (2019) *Journal of Demographic Economics*, vol. 85(2).
- Like Father, Like Son: Inheriting and Bequeathing (2019) *German Economic Review*, vol. 20(2). (with Lars Kunze).
- Tax Evasion, Social Norms and Economic Growth (2019) *Journal of Public Economic Theory*, vol. 21(2). (with Lars Kunze).
- The Effect of Public Pensions on Women's Labor Market Participation over a Full Life-Cycle (2018) *Quantitative Economics*, vol. 9(2). (with Virginia Sánchez-Marcos).
- Temptation and the Efficient Taxation of Education and Labor (2017) *Metroeconomica*, vol. 68(4). (with Lars Kunze).
- Asymmetric Unemployment-Output Tradeoff in the Eurozone (2016) *Journal of Policy Modeling*, vol. 39(3). (with Bo Tang).
- The Political Economics of Redistribution, Inequality and Tax Avoidance (2015) *Public Choice*, vol. 163(3). (with Lars Kunze).
- Declining Predation During Development: A Feedback Process (2015) *Economica*, vol. 82(326). (with Fernando Perera-Tallo).
- Suicide Rates and Economic Crisis in Spain (2014) *European Psychiatry*, vol. 29(S1). (with M. Morera-Fernandez, A. Morera-Fumero, E. Diaz-Mesa, S. Yelmo-Cruz and N. Suarez-Benitez).
- The Living Arrangements of Elderly Widows (2009) *International Economic Review*, vol. 50(3). (with J.V. Ríos-Rull).
- Political Complements in the Welfare State: Health Care and Social Security (2008) *Journal of Public Economics*, vol. 92(3-4). (with V. Galasso).

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Measuring Educational Peer Effects Through Multiple Overlapping Groups. (with Daniel Santos).
- AI Fairness and Equality of Opportunity: A Case Study on Educational Performance. (with Angel Marrero, Gustavo Marrero, Joseph Giovanelli and Roberta Calegari).
- Optimal Retirement Age and Ageing Population. (with Fernando Perera-Tallo).
- The Role of Human Capital Composition in Development and Technological Change. (with Fernando Perera-Tallo).
- Frenemies or Partners? The Political Economy of Income Distribution and Environmental Protection. (with Fernando Perera-Tallo).
- Education, Family Composition, Fertility and Trend. (with José-Víctor Ríos-Rull).

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS (FROM 2020)

- XXVIII Spanish Meeting on Public Economics, A Coruña (Spain), May 2021.
- 15th Conference of the European Sociological Association (ESA), Barcelona (Spain), September 2021.
- 46th Symposium of the Spanish Economic Association (SAEe), Barcelona (Spain), December 2021.
- FAIR Development Workshop, Bergen (Norway), March 2022.
- Add Health Users Conference, Chapel Hill, NC (USA), July 2022.
- 15th IHEA World Congress, Cape Town (South Africa), July 2023.
- Political Economy of Corruption Workshop, New Orleans (USA), May 2023.
- Sixth International Conference on European Economics and Politics, Zurich (Switzerland), June 2024.
- 37th Annual Conference of the European Society for Population Economics (ESPE), Rotterdam, June 2024.
- 11th ECINEQ Conference, Washington, DC (USA), July 2025.

HONOR AND AWARDS

- ULL's Honour Award for Excellent Research, program "Top Impact Papers", 2023 (for two papers JCR Q1).
- Award for High Quality Research under the program "Consolidating Economics" supported by the Ministerio de Innovación y Ciencia, Spain, 2011.
- Award for the Best Doctoral Dissertation in Economics, U. Carlos III de Madrid, 2005.

ORGANIZATION OF INTERNATIONAL RESEARCH ACTIVITIES

- Organizer of conference "Sessions on Sustainable Development at Campus Africa", ULL, 2018.
- Organizer of Workshop "Economía Internacional: Comercio y Finanzas", ULL, 2012-2016.

CONTRIBUTIONS TO EARLY-CAREER RESEARCHERS

Supervision of PhD students

- I currently supervise 1 PhD student, and I have supervised 3 PhD students to the completion of a degree. Based on their thesis, they have published in *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, *Journal of Development Studies*, and *European Psychiatry*.
 - * Daniel Santos Torres, (ULL), Essays in Applied Microeconomics, 2026.
 - * Charlie Y. Ngoudji (ULL), Essays on Fighting Against Malaria, Health and Development in Sub-Saharan Africa, Universitat Graz, 2024.
 - * Loreta Diksaite (ULL), Pharmaceutical companies' stock reactions of M&A announcements and EMA regulatory decisions: a GARCH event study approach, Swedbank, 2016.
 - * Miriam Rodríguez Afonso, (ULL), The production of love: lovemarks and marketing strategies, Universidad Europea, ongoing.

Supervision of M.A. students

- I currently supervise 1 MA student (1 TFM), and I have supervised 13 MA students to the completion of a degree (13 TFM). I have participated in 2 programs: Máster Universitario en Análisis Aplicado para las Ciencias Sociales (2 TFM) and Master en Formación del Profesorado de ESO, Bachillerato, Formación Profesional y Enseñanza de Idiomas (11 TFM).

Supervision of B.A. students

- I currently supervise 1 BA student (1 TFG), and I have supervised 16 BA students to the completion of a degree (16 TFG). I have participated in 3 programs: Economics (6 TFG), Business and Administration (4 TFG) and Labor studies (6 TFG).

Organization of PhD activities

- I have also organized a large number of PhD activities in the 3 PhD programs I have participated: “Derecho Sociedad y Turismo” (2020-present), “Desarrollo Regional” (2022-present), “Economía y Finanzas” (2004-2006).

TEACHING

- Bachelor: Economics, Microeconomics (I, II), Macroeconomics (I, II, III, IV), Research Techniques.
- Master: Economics, Policy Evaluation, Applied Research in Social Sciences, Analysis and monitoring of economic, social, and environmental indicators.
- PhD: Political Economics, Research Techniques.